NSW BIODIVERSITY CREDIT OPPORTUNITY MAP · BRIEFING NOTE

Briefing note: Where to look for new biodiversity credit supply

Topic	Remaining native vegetation for six under-supplied ecosystem credit types, NSW
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Date	11 October 2026
Purpose	To identify IBRA subregions worth investigating for new Biodiversity Stewardship Agreements

Recommendations

1. **Note** the five subregions below as *areas for further investigation* for new credit supply: Inland Slopes, Macleay Hastings, Hill End, Orange and Karuah Manning.
2. **Prioritise** Southwest Ranges White Box Woodland (PCT 3406) around **Hill End and Orange**. It is 89% cleared, has no credits available, and only 0.6% of what remains is protected.
3. **Field-validate** any shortlisted area before engaging landholders. The vegetation map is regional scale, and its accuracy at vegetation-type level is moderate.
4. **Ask DCCEEW to publish** a lookup between retired and current vegetation types (PCTs), so that demand for retired types can be matched to supply.

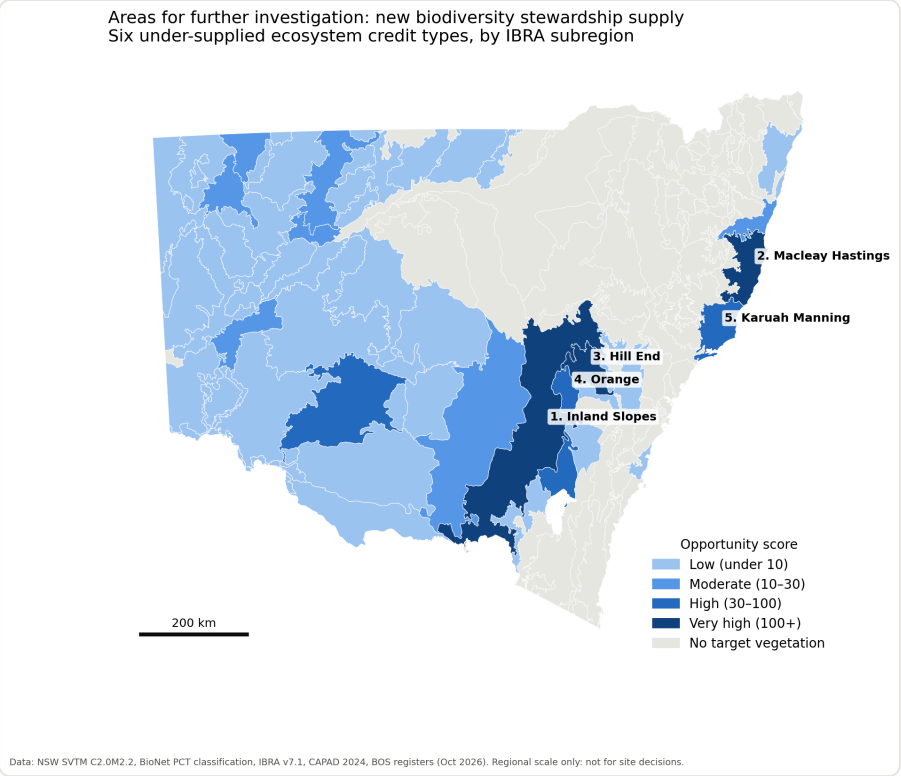
Background

- The Biodiversity Offsets Scheme needs credits for the **same vegetation type** that a development clears (like-for-like).
- Analysis of the BOS public registers (October 2026) shows that 43 credit types have **zero credits available** but are still being retired by developers. This matches the NSW Audit Office (2022) and IPART (2026), which report widespread unmet demand.
- New supply depends on landholders with the **right remnant vegetation** entering stewardship agreements. This note shows where that vegetation remains.

Key findings

Credit type (PCT)	Remaining	Protected	% cleared	Retired/yr	Main subregions
309 Black Cypress Pine – Red Stringybark	7,424 ha	39%	15%	507	Inland Slopes (99%)
290 Red Stringybark – Red Box	42,852 ha	23%	67%	289	Inland Slopes (almost all)
3406 Southwest Ranges White Box	14,988 ha	**0.6%**	**89%**	127	Hill End, Orange (83%)
4047 Northern Swamp Mahogany	4,746 ha	45%	33%	153	Macleay Hastings, Karuah Manning (90%)
24 Canegrass swamp	790,654 ha	10%	20%	155	Bulloo, Lachlan, Paroo Overflow

- **Supply is geographically concentrated.** The two most-demanded types (309 and 290) survive almost only in **Inland Slopes**, so a few landholders there could ease the shortage.
- **The ranking is robust.** The same top five subregions appear under four different weightings, including equal weights.
- **Biodiversity value is high.** Each top subregion has 66–211 threatened species recorded in BioNet. These counts are context only: they reflect survey effort.



Considerations and limitations

- **Mapping accuracy.**
  - Reported vegetation-type accuracy is 57–76% by region (SVTM technical notes, 2022).
  - A Hunter field check found only 17% of labels correct (Hunter, 2016).
  - The map is not site scale.
- **Reclassified types.** PCT 1600 was retired in 2022, and PCT 1604 maps to only 5 ha. Their demand cannot be traced on the current map.
- **% cleared.** BioNet's official figures were used. The pre-clearing map gave very different results (for example, 6% cleared vs 67% for PCT 290).
- **Remnant is not supply.**
  - Tenure, condition and landholder interest are unknown.
  - Each site still needs a full Biodiversity Assessment Method survey.
- **Demand is a lower bound.** It is based on retirements, which miss unmet obligations.
- **Sensitive species.** Only counts per subregion are reported, with no locations, in line with the BioNet Sensitive Species Data Policy.

Next steps

- Share the ranked list with the Biodiversity Conservation Trust for comment.
- Overlay cadastre and tenure for the top five subregions.
- Plan field validation for PCT 3406 around Hill End and Orange.

Sources: DCCEEW SVTM C2.0M2.2; BioNet Vegetation Classification and Atlas; IBRA v7.1; CAPAD 2024; BOS public registers (Oct 2026); Audit Office of NSW (2022); IPART (2026); Hunter (2016) Ecological Management & Restoration 17(1).